

Once you have downloaded the .torrent file, your BitTorrent client will kick in and connect to a managing computer that then connects you to others who have the files. So why would you want to go to Web sites first to download the header file? What makes this network different from any other?

Speed. This is the biggest advantage on the Torrent network. Unlike earlier P2P networks, downloading using this network is a dream since you are only limited by bandwidth and the number of seeds available. If both are high, rest assured, downloading gigabytes of data is all in a day's work.

The Web sites listing the torrents are called indexing sites and have become very popular. Their popularity has come at a cost, though with the MPAA and law enforcement agencies shutting them down. There is also no shortage of sites to go to so long as you know which are currently being used, as they come and go rather quickly these days. Most indexing sites have a system of listing the number of Seeders and Leechers for a particular archive.

Seeder(s) are those users who have at least one complete copy of the archive with them and are sharing it on the BitTorrent network. However, for any user's download to complete, you will need at least one seeder who has the complete copy. Under certain circumstances though, there may be no one seeder but enough people with all the parts to make up the whole archive, which is called a distributed copy.

Leecher is a user who starts downloading from the BitTorrent network and then carries on downloading by connecting to different seeders. In the BitTorrent network, though, a leecher is part of the network and is uploading as well, many times more KB than they download. This ensures that all users on the network get an equal opportunity to download the file.

BitTorrent and eDonkey2000 are the most used networks today. Web sites and forums that support the use and expansion of